



Set Up Your Own Property Tool.

A plain-English guide — no coding, and you never open or edit a single file. If you can install an app and copy-and-paste into a website, you can do this. We go one small step at a time and tell you exactly what you'll see after each one.

~20 min

start to finish

Double-click

no terminal, no code

Your PC

your data stays home

Your own private property-lookup tool, running on your computer — at the data companies' cost, with no software markup, no per-seat fees, and no credits that expire.

Three phases. You can stop after two.

Here's the entire journey before we start, so nothing is a surprise. You'll only ever **double-click** and **use your web browser** — never a command, never a file.

1

Install the engine

ONE-TIME

Install one free app, Docker Desktop — the "motor" OpenProp runs on. Install it once and forget it.

2

Turn OpenProp on

FREE

Double-click one file. OpenProp opens in your web browser. You can look up any U.S. address right away.

3

Add your data (the keys)

OPTIONAL

Owner names, values, equity, phone numbers, AI search — each is a "key" you paste into the app's Settings page. Add what you need.

You never touch code or files. After Phase 2, OpenProp already works — address, flood zone, and neighborhood income, free. Phase 3 is a menu you turn on inside the app, by pasting keys. There's no wrong order and nothing to break.

Install the engine

PHASE 1

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One free app, installed once. ~10-15 minutes, mostly waiting.

1 Find out which computer you have

This decides which download button to click — it takes 5 seconds.

ON A MAC

Click the **Apple logo** (very top-left corner of your screen) → **About This Mac**. If it says **M1**, **M2**, **M3** or **M4**, you have "Apple Silicon." If it says **Intel**, you have "Intel." (Most Macs since 2021 are Apple Silicon.)

ON WINDOWS

You almost certainly want the plain **Windows** version — that's it.

2 Download Docker Desktop

In your web browser, go to the address below and click the blue button that matches your computer from Step 1:

➤ docker.com/products/docker-desktop

What you'll see: a file downloading — **Docker.dmg** on Mac, or **Docker Desktop Installer.exe** on Windows.

3 Install it

ON A MAC

Open your **Downloads** folder, double-click **Docker.dmg**. A window pops up — **drag the whale icon onto the Applications folder** shown next to it. Then open **Docker** from your Applications folder and click **Accept / Use recommended settings**.

ON WINDOWS

Double-click the installer, click **OK / Install**, and let it **restart your PC** if it asks. Then open **Docker Desktop** from the Start menu and click **Accept**.

Don't skip the drag on Mac. Running Docker from inside the little pop-up window causes errors — drag it into **Applications** first, then open it from there.

4 Wait for the whale

The first launch takes a minute or two while it sets itself up. Just wait — you don't need to click anything or make an account.

You're done when: a small **whale icon** 🐋 appears — in the **top-right menu bar** on Mac, or the **bottom-right tray** on Windows (click the ▲ arrow to show hidden icons) — and it stops moving. Leave Docker running; that's all Phase 1 needs.

Turn OpenProp on

PHASE 2

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Download, unzip, double-click — it opens in your browser.
~5 min.

1

Download OpenProp

When you bought OpenProp you got a **download link** — on the page right after you paid, and again in your **email receipt**. Click it and choose **Save**. The file lands in your computer's **Downloads** folder.

What you'll see: a file named `openprop.zip` in your Downloads folder.

2

Unzip it

Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click `openprop.zip`. A folder named **openprop** appears. Drag that folder onto your **Desktop** so it's easy to find.

3

Double-click "Start OpenProp"

First check that **Docker is running** — the **whale icon** 🐳 should be showing from Phase 1 (it usually starts on its own). Then open the **openprop** folder on your Desktop. Right there — not in any sub-folder — is the file for your computer. Double-click it:

Mac `Start OpenProp.command` · **Windows** `Start OpenProp.bat`

Mac may say "unidentified developer." If it blocks the file, **right-click** it → **Open** → **Open**. You only do this once, ever.

What you'll see: a black window opens and shows progress. **The first time takes a few minutes** while it builds your tool — this is normal. Leave the window; after this it starts in seconds.

4

Log in

Your browser opens by itself to your new tool. If it doesn't within a minute, open your browser and type this into the address bar:

➤ `localhost:8787`

In the **Password** box type the starting password, then click the green **Sign in** button:

Password `changeme`



You're in — that's the setup.

Look up any U.S. address now — location, flood zone, and income, all free. Start/stop anytime with the `Start OpenProp` / `Stop OpenProp` files; turn the page to add more.

PHASE 3

Add your data — the keys

FINTOK · OPENPROP

Optional. Each key unlocks more, and it's all done inside the app.



How to add any key — the same 3 clicks every time

1. In OpenProp, click **Settings** — the small link in the very **top-right corner**.
2. You'll see a labeled box for each key. **Paste** your key into the box with the matching name, then click the green **Save** button.
3. On the right, the "**Active now**" list shows a **green dot** ● next to whatever you just switched on. Done — no restart, ever.

A note on "free" tiers: the free plans below are only for trying things — they cap out fast and will block you mid-search. For real work, use the paid usage (it's small — see the costs on the next page) so you're never rate-limited.



RentCast

Owner name, property details, tax history — the essentials

~\$74/mo

for 1,000 lookups

1. Go to **app.rentcast.io/app/api** and click **Sign In** → create an account (email or Google).
2. Click **Select Plan**. For real use pick a paid plan; to just try it, the free **Developer** plan gives 50 lookups.
3. Click **Create API Key**, name it anything, and **copy** the key.
4. In OpenProp: Settings → paste into **RentCast API key** → **Save**.

⌚ ~5 min 💡 Free tier is 50/mo, then it blocks — a paid plan is ~7¢/lookup

Key: **a long 32-character code**



Anthropic (Claude)

The AI: plain-English search, property briefs, lead scores, outreach drafts

~\$5–20/mo

pay as you go

1. Go to **console.anthropic.com** and sign up (email or Google), confirming your email.
2. Click **Billing** → add a card → **Buy credits** (the ~\$5 minimum). **Do this first** — the key won't work without credit.
3. Click **API Keys** → **Create Key**, then **copy it right away** (it's shown only once).
4. In OpenProp: Settings → paste into **Anthropic API key** → **Save**.

⌚ ~5 min 🇺🇸 A few cents per AI action; you prepay and spend down slowly Key starts with **sk-ant-**



HUD & Census

Fair-market rents by bedroom + neighborhood median income

Free

real gov data

HUD (rents): at huduser.gov/hudapi/public/register make a free account and tick the "Fair Market Rents" box. Create a token, then Settings → **HUD FMR token**.

Census (income): at api.census.gov/data/key_signup.html fill the short form, then click the activation link in the email. Then Settings → **Census API key**.

🕒 ~10 min for both

⚠️ HUD: must tick **Fair Market Rents**

⚠️ Census: must **click the email link**



Apify (skip trace)

Find the owner's phone number and email from a property address

~10–20¢

per lookup

1. Go to console.apify.com/sign-up, sign up (email or Google), and click the verification email.
2. Click your **profile picture** (top-right) → **Settings** → **API & Integrations**, then copy your **Personal API token**.
3. In OpenProp Settings: set **Skip-trace vendor** = **apify**, paste the token into **Skip-trace API key** → **Save**.

🕒 ~4 min



You pay only when you pull a contact

Token starts with

apify_api_



RealEstateAPI

Home value, equity, mortgage balance, and distress flags (foreclosure, liens)

Trial

then premium

1. Go to realestateapi.com and click **Start Free Trial**; sign up with your email. You may be asked to book a short call to switch your account on — that's normal.
2. Log in at dashboard.realestateapi.com → open the **Keys** section → copy your **API key**.
3. In OpenProp: Settings → paste into **RealEstateAPI key** → **Save**.

🕒 ~5–10 min



The **one premium option** — great free trial, but ~\$600/mo to keep, so most people skip it

Which keys do you actually need? For most people: **RentCast** (the essentials) + **Claude** (the AI) + the free **HUD/Census** data. Add **Apify** when you want phone numbers. **RealEstateAPI** is only worth it if deep equity/distress data is central to your business.

What it really costs.

OpenProp itself is free — you only pay the data companies for what you use, at **their** price, with no markup. Here's an honest, slightly-high estimate so nothing surprises you.

RentCast — owner, property & tax

The core data. About 7¢ a lookup on a paid plan.

\$0–74

free to try · ~\$74/mo real use

Claude AI — search, briefs, scoring

A few cents per action, prepaid and spent down.

\$5–20

per month, as you use it

Skip trace — phone & email

Only when you pull a contact. ~10–20¢ each.

\$0–20

per month, usage-based

Rents · income · flood (HUD, Census, FEMA)

Real U.S. government data. No meaningful limits.

\$0

always free

RealEstateAPI — equity & distress

Optional. Generous trial; pricey to keep.

trial

~\$600/mo after — most skip it

YOUR LIKELY BILL

Occasional (a few lookups a week) **~\$15–25/mo**

Active (hunting deals daily) **~\$90–110/mo**

...and you're paying the data companies directly — at cost, no seats, no expiring credits.

THE USUAL SUBSCRIPTION TOOLS

\$100–200+/mo

A subscription forever, a marked-up price, per-seat fees, and skip-trace credits that expire if you don't use them.

Rule of thumb: only add the keys you'll actually use, and keep an eye on the spend meter at the top of the app. It caps paid calls at a limit you set in Settings.



FINTOK.NEWS

You own it now.

OpenProp runs on your computer, with your keys, showing your searches to no one. No subscription, no seat fee, no expiring credits. Start it any time by double-clicking **Start OpenProp** in the openprop folder.

It's private

Everything saves on your machine. Your lookups and notes never leave it.

It's yours

Keys are pasted in Settings and can be changed or removed anytime. No lock-in.

It's honest

You pay the data providers at cost — no markup, no expiring credits, no surprises.



FINTOK.NEWS

OpenProp — made to be owned, not rented.